Standard Operating Procedure:
CR Lifecycle & Release Management

Version: 2.0 | **Process Owner:** IT / Project Management Office

This document establishes the master workflow for processing Change Requests (CRs), governing the end-to-end lifecycle from initial scoping and resource allocation through development, User Acceptance Testing (UAT), and production deployment.

1. Organizational Structure & Project Assignment

The system operates on a structured hierarchy governed by the System Administrator. The admin is responsible for defining member responsibilities and assigning projects. A core operational rule is that **multiple projects can be assigned to a single person** across the reporting lines.

1.1 Authentication & Visibility

The platform utilizes **Google Login (SSO)** for secure access. User creation is delegated down the organizational chain; for instance, a Project Manager registers a Developer by submitting their Name, Employment ID, and official Gmail address. Once authenticated via Google, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) ensures users only see the specific projects and CRs explicitly assigned to them by their superiors.

The hierarchy branches into three distinct operational tracks: Engineering/Development, Business Analysis, and Quality Assurance (UAT), as illustrated below:

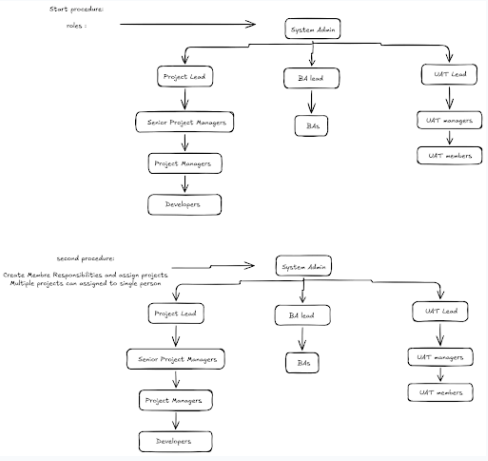


Figure 1: Role Hierarchy (Reference: https://lh3.googleusercontent.com/gg-dl/AHiVA1nWpO7vlXmHAUd4snbQKA1p7yUZcLbRUa1iKYMrBgupfDEeMuScFs0w7mKGAC54Qila03nAUn_ovxLP-ekSp2r75J_9T_81mb9DvmQRS_z47Bz_FXTDbxPSLo1yAshaT6UV99EtWvbJ4ZkgCspFcdmbD6J9hNey2v4dXqpxcSlRht

2. Roles & Responsibilities

- **System Admin:** Creates user profiles, assigns responsibilities and projects, and manages global configurations (e.g., automated email toggles, direct BA dispatch permissions).
- **Project Lead:** Performs initial technical review of CRs, manages early scope/deadline negotiations, and escalates complex requests.
- **Senior Project Manager (SPM):** Handles escalations, provides final executive approval for Software Release Notes (SRNs), and oversees Project Managers.
- **Project Manager (PM):** Reviews SRNs, allocates specific task assignments to developers, and enforces master deadlines.
- **Developer:** Executes code changes, logs progress, maps exact release impacts (modules and screens), and generates bundled SRNs and Bug Fix releases.
- **BA Lead & Business Analyst (BA):** Initiates CRs, defines technical scope, acts as the final gatekeeper before UAT deployment, and manages CR "Hold" statuses.
- **UAT Lead, Managers, & Members:** Test deployments and log bugs. The UAT track only gains system access to assign bugs *after* final SRN approval and dispatch. They generate final production artifacts.

3. Global System Feature: Comprehensive Audit Trail

> **CR Activity Tracker**
> A dedicated "CR Activity Tab" is globally accessible in the navigation menu. Clicking any SRN or CR reveals a chronological, timestamped history detailing:
>
> - CR creation and initiation.
> - Acceptance, escalations, and deadline negotiations.
> - SRN Reviews (by PM) and Approvals (by SPM/BA).
> - Email dispatch timestamps.
> - Bug creation logs (UAT) and bug fix release timestamps (Developers).

4. Workflow Phase 1: Initiation & Allocation

Step 1.1: Initiation (Business Analyst)

The BA fetches a new CR from Zoho or initiates an internal CR. The BA details the technical specifications, explicitly outlining which modules require changes and defining whether existing screens will be modified or new screens added. The CR is then submitted to the Project Lead.

Step 1.2: Technical Review (Project Lead)

The PL reviews the scope and timeline. The PL may negotiate deadlines or scope adjustments directly with the BA. Once aligned, the PL accepts the CR. If higher-level oversight is required, the PL escalates the request to the PM or SPM.

Step 1.3: Escalation & Task Allocation (PM / SPM)

The SPM/PM reviews escalated CRs, finalizes negotiations, and provides acceptance. The PM then breaks down the work, assigning either the full CR or specific modules to the development team. The PM sets task deadlines that strictly align with the master CR deadline.

5. Workflow Phase 2: Execution & Tracking

Step 2.1: Execution (Developer)

Developers execute their assigned modules or full CRs. Upon completion, they update the system status to "Development Completed."

Step 2.2: Overdue Protocol

If a task is marked complete after the PM's assigned deadline, the system enforces a mandatory remark field where the developer must explain the reason for the delay.

Step 2.3: Automated Tracking

The system logs exact completion timestamps and updates the overall progress of the master CR. If configured by the Admin, automated alerts are dispatched to relevant personnel regarding task completions and overdue warnings.

6. Workflow Phase 3: UAT Preparation & SRN Generation

Step 3.1: Release Mapping (Developer)

Once internal code checks are finalized, the developer changes the CR status to "UAT". Developers may bundle multiple completed CRs into a single release request. The developer must explicitly map the release impact, selecting the exact modules (e.g., Registration, Master) and the specific screens modified.

Step 3.2: Automated SRN Compilation

The system complies the bundled release into a strictly formatted Software Release Note (SRN) document, separating new features from bug fixes.

7. Workflow Phase 4: Management Approval & Dispatch

Step 4.1: Management Sign-off

The PM reviews the generated SRN, acting as the official Reviewer. The SPM provides executive sign-off, acting as the Approver. The SRN is then routed to the BA.

Step 4.2: BA Gatekeeping

The BA serves as the final gatekeeper. They may approve the deployment or place it on "Hold" (which requires a mandatory reason and optional deadline adjustment). If held, the system alerts the BA when the hold period expires.

Step 4.3: SRN Dispatch & UAT Unlock

The approved SRN is dispatched via email to the UAT team. **Critical security rule:** Only after the SRN is fully approved and the email is successfully dispatched does the system unlock the CR, making it visible to the UAT team in their Bug Assign Screen.

8. Workflow Phase 5: Testing, Bugs & Production

Step 5.1: Testing & Unified Email Threading

The UAT team tests the changes against the mapped screens. If bugs are found, they are logged and assigned to developers. When a developer issues a fix, they generate a Bug Fix SRN. The system automatically sends this Bug Fix SRN as a **reply to the original SRN email thread**, ensuring all release communication remains consolidated.

Step 5.2: Production Preparation

Once all items pass testing, UAT marks the status as "Ready for Production" and generates three mandatory artifacts: the Production SRN, a Deployment Checklist, and a Request for Change (RFC). The final package is emailed to stakeholders, finalizing the lifecycle.

9. Standardized SRN Format

All dispatched SRNs (both Initial and Bug Fix) must strictly adhere to the following template structure:

Author: [Developer / Sender Name]
Reviewed By: [Project Manager Name]
Approved By: [Senior Project Manager Name]

New Features / Enhancements

Sr no.	CR id	Description	Impacted modules with screen
1	[CR-ID]	[Detailed description of feature]	[Module] - [Screen Name]

Bug Fixes

Sr no.	Bug id	Description	Impacted modules with screen
1	[BUG-ID]	[Detailed description of fix]	[Module] - [Screen Name]